SAM UFFINDELL
MP for Tauranga

National

Autumn 2026 Newsletter



Representing Tauranga

I love being the Member of Parliament for Tauranga and having the opportunity to meet with many of you and represent our amazing hometown at Parliament. I hope you enjoy reading my Autumn newsletter that provides news, updates and advice for residents of Tauranga. I look forward to connecting with constituents and businesses throughout the electorate in the coming months - please reach out to me for advice or to share your feedback.

Mount Maunganui



Following the tragic landslide on Mount Maunganui / Mauao earlier this year, our community continues to feel the impact and loss of what occurred.

Thank you to our amazing community for coming together so well in this time and for all the love, support and care you showed. To our first responders - thank you for your selfless dedication to helping those in need. Also, a massive thank you to everyone that lent a hand to help out and donated food, goods and other items to support the rescue and recovery effort.

We need to get down to the Mount and help out those struggling businesses and work towards its gradual reopening. We have a wonderful community - we stand strong together - thank you for everything.

Building a Safer New Zealand

Public safety has been a major focus with 49,000 fewer victims of violent crime recorded in the year ending October 2025 compared to two years prior. Serious repeat youth offending has also decreased by 22%.

To support this progress the Government has established twelve new and expanded community beat teams to increase police presence. Additionally police now have the authority to issue move on orders for up to twenty four hours to manage disorderly behaviour in public spaces. Legislative changes including the restoration of the Three Strikes law and the criminalisation of stalking are further strengthening the approach to sentencing and crime prevention.

Relief for Household Costs

Efforts to manage the cost of living have resulted in a stabilisation of property and rental prices and inflation of 3.1% (down from 7.3%). Direct relief measures have been introduced such as the reduction of driver licence fees and the implementation of twelve-month prescriptions. Households are being supported by the reduction of the Official Cash Rate, down from 5.5% to 2.25%.

Strengthening Healthcare

Healthcare has seen a significant advancement with the funding for 33 new cancer drugs to improve patient outcomes nationwide. In Tauranga we have greatly expanded the number of intensive care unit and coronary care unit beds. Expanding critical care capacity will improve patient flow from the emergency department for unplanned admissions and reduce the need to delay planned surgeries.

Advancing Education

The Government continues to boost the teacher workforce, supply teacher aides throughout NZ and ensure kids are at school. Results in literacy and numeracy have improved dramatically since we implemented an hour-a-day of reading, writing and maths and gave teachers and students the tools to succeed. Students learning under the new curriculum, an hour-a-day of maths, and using high quality resources, made on average a full year's progress in just 12 weeks!









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National

The Regional Deal



A Regional Deal will deliver jobs, better incomes, and long-term certainty for key infrastructure locally. Projects include Takitimu Northern Link to Ōmokoroa, Tauriko West SH29 and SH29A upgrades. This also means thousands of new homes and other vital regional projects. Tauranga and the Western Bay could be the first city in New Zealand to secure such a regional deal.

Economic Growth and Trade

The economy continues to grow through international trade and investment. A landmark Free Trade Agreement with India was announced in late 2025 and the National Infrastructure Plan has been delivered to provide a long-term roadmap for the country. The tourism sector has seen a notable recovery; the December 2025 year was the first annual period to exceed 3.5 million overseas visitor arrivals since the March 2020 year. Furthermore, the Active Investor Plus program has delivered $3 billion in investment to our economy.

ANZAC Day: Saturday 25 April 2026



We'll be commemorating our military veterans on ANZAC Day, which is in few weeks. In February Parliament passed the ANZAC Day Amendment Act. This ensures that ANZAC Day formally honours all New Zealanders who have served in times of war and conflict. This includes those who served after 1966 and personnel from allied forces such as France and India. It's only right that, on this special day for New Zealand, we honour everyone who served our country.

Supporting the Disability Community

Changes to the Total Mobility scheme have been implemented, ensuring continued access for the disability community to essential transport subsidies for their daily needs.

Infrastructure and Housing

Major roading projects in the Bay of Plenty are reaching key milestones. The Pāpāmoa East Interchange is in its final construction phase and is expected to open in late March 2026. This project includes a new bridge over the Tauranga Eastern Link and the extension of Te Okuroa Drive. The Ōmokoroa roundabout is also nearing completion this month while work continues on the Takitimu North Link, on State Highway 29 at Tauriko West and the Omanawa Bridge replacement.

To address housing needs we are replacing the Resource Management Act with a much more permissive scheme that protects private property rights, reduces red tape and enables faster and more efficient development.

Energy and Environment



To ensure national energy security the government is facilitating the delivery of Liquefied Natural Gas. This will result in lower energy prices for Kiwi households and businesses while reducing our current reliance on emission-intensive Indonesian coal.

Environmental protection remains a priority with new restrictions on commercial fishing in the Hauraki Gulf to protect marine life and the delivery of long awaited decisions on stewardship land.

Cabinet Connections

It's always a pleasure to host my colleagues when they visit the Tauranga electorate. As a key strategic city for the New Zealand economy, Tauranga features on many ministerial itineraries. Below I'm hosting Hon Scott Simpson, Minister for ACC, visiting his department on Grey Street. Hon Chris Bishop addressed the infrastructure sector on topics relating to regional transport and property development. Hon Matt Doocey launched two mental health programmes with Health NZ and Police personnel. Hon Simeon Brown visited medical suppliers Cubro and dropped by Tauranga Hospital with Black Clash players to visit fans in the paediatric and geriatric wards.







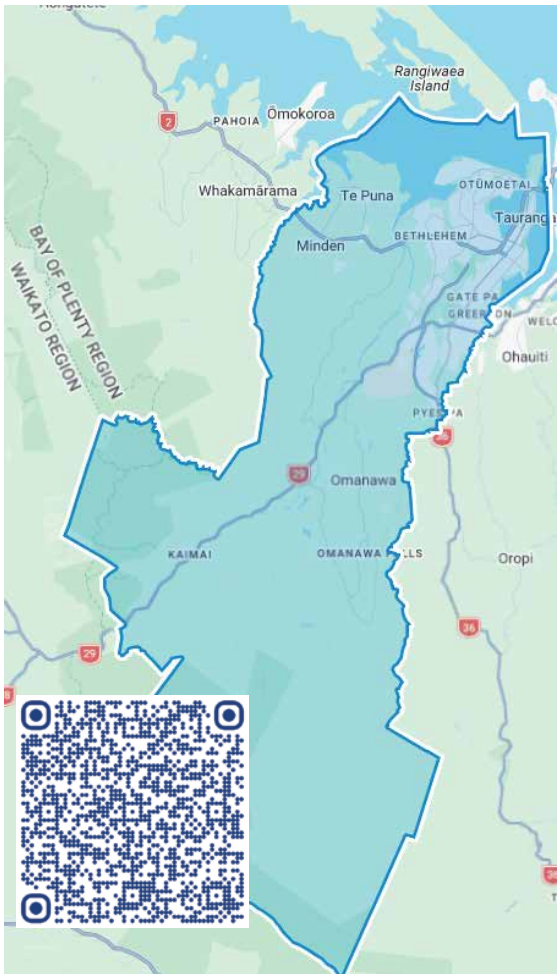


Services offered by your Tauranga Electorate Member of Parliament.

If you live in the Tauranga electorate, or run a business here, my team and I are available to support you. As your Electorate MP, I represent Tauranga in Parliament, which debates and passes legislation to become law, in Wellington.

The House typically sits Tuesday to Thursday for 30 weeks per year. My electorate office on Grey Street is open Monday to Friday, 10 am–4 pm. I hold a weekly Constituent Clinic on Monday afternoons with 15-minute slots, and drop-in clinics in other suburbs including Greerton, Otumoetai and Pyes Pa. Let me know if you'd like to attend one in your own suburb.

Tauranga Electorate 2026 Boundary Map



New Zealand's General Election has been set for Saturday 7 November 2026. You can register for the electoral roll or update your details at www.vote.nz.

With new boundaries announced last year, you may be in a different electorate from last time you voted. The new Tauranga electorate boundary will encompass a greater area from last election, taking in Lower Kaimai and Te Puna.

To explore the changes, scan the QR code to view the interactive map.

Assistance for Constituents

On House sitting weeks I'm typically in Wellington Tuesday to Thursday, and in my electorate on Mondays and Fridays. My office remains staffed throughout the week so feel free to phone or email any time to make an appointment or ask for help.

Here are some resources available to my constituents:

- Discreet and experienced staff to connect constituents with government agencies like ACC, Work and Income, Police, Immigration NZ, Tauranga Hospital and other agencies and social services.
- Nominating Justices of the Peace; if you'd like to help your community as a JP, my office can send you an application pack and, after a meeting where I sign your nomination, I'll submit it to the Associate Justice Minister for consideration.
- The Parliamentary Library is a valuable resource with many current and historic publications accessible to MPs and their constituents; let me know your information request and, if it's in their database, the Library's researchers will be happy to send it.
- If you want to make your voice heard or suggest a law change on a national issue, I can present your petition to Parliament for consideration by the appropriate Select Committee.
  Petitions must be presented by an MP to progress through the Parliamentary process; please get in touch to arrange yours.
- Tours of Parliament - if you're visiting Wellington we can connect you with the tour desk to make a booking, and if you're going with a school, we can set you up with a visit to the Mini Parliament.
- Congratulations - if you have a loved one celebrating a 100th birthday or a wedding anniversary greater than 50 years, you can submit a request for an official congratulatory message from your MP and from other dignitaries. My team can send you details.

Caring Community

My team and I work closely with many services as we support Tauranga constituents. In addition to government agencies there are some incredible people providing advice and advocacy. Here are some folks I've met recently.

Baywide Community Law provides free legal information and one-on-one legal advice to people on low incomes, with disabilities or other disadvantages. There is a range of resources for self-help at www.baywidecls.org.nz or call 0800 905 916. If you don't yet have a will or a Power of Attorney, the website contains suggestions to ensure your wishes are respected if you can't speak for yourself.



It's heartbreaking to see animals mistreated but the **SPCA** is always busy caring for pets that have been poorly trained, abandoned or injured. Please, if you bring an animal home, remember that it's a member of your family for up to 20 years. The team at Alach Street in Greerton rely on volunteers to foster animals till they're ready to be homed. To see how you can help, call the Tauranga team on 07 578 0245. Please remember that all dogs can be dangerous, regardless of breed. If you can't control your dog, ensure it's leashed, neutered and muzzled for the safety of our community.





You Ok Bro? You've probably seen local legend Scotty by his van on the side of the road. He's supported 1,000 people who stopped for a yarn since 2023. No need for appointments, no obligations, no fees.

Social worker Scotty also supports local businesses with workplace wellbeing tools. @uokbro.nz on Facebook.



The team at **Bay Financial Mentors** provides financial mentoring, advocacy, and education so every person has sustainable financial well-being for themselves and future generations. Their services range from crisis support and ongoing mentoring to financial capability workshops that build confidence and resilience. The service is free and confidential. Mentors are available to ensure you don't have to face financial challenges on your own.

For an appointment, please call 0800 BFM 123.

Mental Health Assistance

- Tauranga Crisis Team: 0800 800 508 or 111 if someone's in immediate danger
- Text 1737 for a trained counsellor
- Lifeline 0800 543 354, or text 4357
- Youthline: 0800 376 633
- Samaritans: 0800 726 666



Turning Point in the Historic Village provides a mental health and addiction recovery service in a supportive environment for adults to develop skills, build relationships, and work toward personal recovery goals through creative and vocational programmes.

07 578 6934 www.turningpoint.org.nz

SuperSupport is a multi-agency initiative connecting superannuitants with community support if they are struggling financially or facing health and mobility challenges. It provides free pre-cooked meals and basic pantry supplies directly to those in need and helps with issues relating to social isolation, health and mobility difficulties.



Administered by Tauranga City Council, SuperSupport is provided by **Here To Help U** with the help of long term Tauranga support agencies **Good Neighbour**, **Age Concern**, **Bay Financial Mentors** and the **Tauranga Community Foodbank**.

Here to help U provides wider support services for people in Tauranga and is a fast and easy way for people to request free wellbeing support. No barriers, judgment or stress; just help.

Call 0800 568 273 or request help at www.heretohelpu.nz.

Age Concern Tauranga provides essential support by helping older residents navigate key health services and community organisations. They offer advice on Advanced Care Planning and Enduring Powers of Attorney, while promoting safety through elder abuse and scam awareness.



To foster independence, they host regular meetings and the *Staying Safe Refresher Course for Older Drivers*, the *Steady As You Go*, *Total Mobility Scheme*, *Social Connection and Visiting Service*, *Focus on Falls Prevention*, advocacy, and reducing isolation through meaningful companionship.

07 578 2631 - www.ageconcerntauranga.org.nz

Starting over a decade ago with a food rescue service, feeding those who are struggling while reducing food waste from landfill, **Good Neighbour** has continued to expand its range of initiatives to support the Tauranga community. Support for people in crisis, backyard property maintenance for those unable to manage it on their own, community gardens, property maintenance free gear hire, cooking lessons, youth life skill programs, work experience, social work, community meals and firewood provision are some of the ways they provide practical help, facilitate key connections and address poverty to improve neighbourhoods and build relationships. www.goodneighbour.co.nz



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